



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cabrini Co-op
School Website: <https://cabrinicoop.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cabrinini Co-op Id 83814 presents a robust Catholic, homeschool-cooperative model that strongly foregrounds religious formation, liturgical life, and family partnership. Public materials repeatedly emphasize Catholic identity, sacramental life, and the domestic church as central to learning, while curriculum highlights memory work, faith-infused humanities, and reverence for tradition. While the school demonstrates many core classical markers, it does not consistently foreground the full Great Books framework, the Seven Liberal Arts explicitly, or explicit Socratic pedagogy across all levels. Overall classification across categories largely centers in the CLASSICAL space, with especially strong alignment in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, and Community/Parent Partnership. Some categories show only partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), notably Curriculum and Pedagogy. The aggregate assessment leans CLASSICAL, with a clear emphasis on formation, virtue, liturgy, and Catholic intellectual heritage.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence of strong Catholic/theological orientation, liturgy, Sacraments, and catechesis. Positive indicators include liturgy, catechesis, Sacraments, theology, and the domestic-church framing. No explicit negative signals observed in public materials. Why: The school's mission and day-to-day practice center on theology, liturgical life, and sacred practices, aligning with transcendental realism and liturgical community indicators.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** Evidence of formation over information; emphasis on virtue, faith, and character within a Catholic formation framework. The mission frames education as part of forming persons within the domestic church rather than mere credentialing. Why: The core aim is formation through faith and reason, not merely job preparation.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence of faith-infused liberal-arts-adjacent content (memory work, rhetoric/writing, history, liturgical calendar, CGS). However, explicit Great Books, Seven Liberal Arts, and direct reference to a formal Great Conversation are not clearly foregrounded in public materials. Why: Strong classical-adjacent elements exist (memory work, rhetoric, liturgy, primary religious texts), but foundational elements like Great Books and the explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framework are not clearly stated.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence of a contemplative/restful orientation (Scholé) and memory-focused activities, plus small-class dialogue. Public materials do not consistently present explicit Socratic seminars, debates, or high-school-level rhetoric curricula, though dialogue and discussion are present in spirit. Why: Elements of contemplative learning and memory-work exist; but explicit Socratic pedagogy and formal upper-level rhetoric/debate practices are not consistently documented.
- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence of founders/directors and board members; volunteers and curriculum decisions show leadership and mentorship. The explicit notion of the "living curriculum" or formal teacher portraits is not strongly stated in public materials. Why: Leadership and mentorship are present, but the explicit classical-faculty portrait and "living curriculum" portrayal are not clearly articulated.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL** Evidence of deep parent partnership and a strong, active parent-led structure; families are described as founders, co-educators, and integral to gover-

nance and day-to-day life. Open invitation to parental involvement and multiple family-focused activities is evident. Why: The program emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation, and ongoing parental involvement, aligning with classical-community indicators.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (only applies if some categories are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Explicitly articulate and publish a formal Great Books / Great Conversation component and connect it to a modern, cohesive plan that includes primary sources and canonical texts.
- Make the Trivium/Quadrivium elements explicit in Curriculum, with clear grammar, logic, and rhetoric strands mapped to grade levels.
- Expand explicit Socratic pedagogy across upper grades with defined seminar structures and teacher-led scaffolding to cultivate dialectic and argumentative discourse.
- Strengthen the Faculty narrative: publish a living-curriculum profile of teachers, including how teachers model virtue and how mentorship is enacted day-to-day.
- Deepen visible alignment of pedagogy to Scholé by documenting specific restful-learning days, contemplative practices, and memory work in classroom routines.

ABSTRACT

Cabrinini Co-op Id 83814 demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation through its Catholic formation focus, liturgical partnership, and family-centered educational model. The school emphasizes formation (virtue, faith, and wisdom) within a domestic-church framework, with strong evidence of liturgical life, sacraments, and catechesis, aligning with the transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practices described in the classical rubric. Curriculum and pedagogy show classical-adjacent features (memory work, writing/rhetoric, reverence for tradition), but explicit Great Books engagement, the Seven Liberal Arts framework, and universal Socratic pedagogy are less overt in public documents. The faculty and governance structures show leadership and mentorship, though a full portrayal of the “living curriculum” remains under-documented publicly. Parents and community engagement are deeply integrated and central to the model.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Cabrinini Co-op demonstrates a strong classical alignment in religious formation and community partnership, with clear opportunities for deeper classical articulation in curriculum, pedagogy, and faculty portrait.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission framing emphasizes Catholic formation and the domestic Church; sacraments and liturgical life are central to learning. The mission text explicitly anchors education in Sacraments and Catholic life (e.g., “Empowering the Domestic Church through the Sacraments, Family Life and a Catholic Education.”)
- Public materials describe the Co-op as Christ-centered and Catholic, with daily Mass, CGS, and liturgical calendar integration.
- Curriculum references catechesis of the Good Shepherd (CGS) and liturgical practices alongside faith-based formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): Catholic; Sacraments; liturgy; liturgical calendar; theology; catechesis; CGS; domestic Church; Christ-centered; daily Mass. These align with Positive Keywords from the Six Essential Elements lexicon (theology, liturgy, catechesis, sacraments, sacred life, etc.).
- Negative Keywords: Not prominently present (no clear values-neutral or secular framing in public content).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground sacred and transcendent categories (theology, liturgy, sacramental life) and a communal liturgical life, consistent with TRANSCENDENTAL moral realism and liturgical practice. This maps well to the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the classical rubric.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on forming the entire person within a Catholic framework, not simply job preparation. The phrase “Empowering the Domestic Church through the Sacraments, Family Life and a Catholic Education” anchors purpose in formation and faith.
- The Co-op emphasizes growth in both faith and reason; expectations describe a “reflective, discerning, joyful Catholic” (formation of character and intellect).
- Curricular and program notes (e.g., Catholic Enrichment, CGS, liturgical calendar) indicate formation through faith-integrated learning rather than a purely information- or job-oriented aim.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): formation; virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; contemplation; faith and reason; domestic Church; virtue formation; sacred tradition; liturgy. These align with the Positive Keywords for School Purpose and Goal in the Six Elements lexicon.
- Negative Keywords: Not apparent; no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness or career-competency framing in public content.

Why this rating

- The materials prioritize formation, virtue, and the reality of truth/beauty in education, consistent with the Classical orientation toward formation rather than mere information or job preparation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Curriculum includes memory work, Catholic enrichment, and a history/science sequence anchored by faith-based providers (e.g., TAN Academy materials; The Story of Civilization; catechesis; liturgical elements).
- Specific subjects listed: Mathematics (RightStart Math, Singapore Math), Language Arts (Foundations A/B by Logic of English), Writing & Rhetoric (IEW), History (The Story of Civilization by TAN), Science (Apologia; TAN Academy), Literature/Poetry (Harp & Laurel Wreath). These are faith-infused and heavily skill/discipline-oriented, with a clear emphasis on memory work and virtue literature.
- The program emphasizes Catechesis of the Good Shepherd and liturgical/faith-infused study alongside core subjects.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): memory work; rhetoric; catechesis; CGS; liturgical calendar; virtue literature; Western-tradition-oriented texts; The Story of Civilization; sacred literature; theology integrated with content. These map to Positive Keywords in the Curriculum and related elements (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, etc.).
- Negative Keywords: There is no explicit statement of Great Books/Great Conversation as a canonical framework, and Seven Liberal Arts are not explicitly named as a formal framework in the public curriculum. The materials instead emphasize faith-based texts and curricular sequences. This signals a partial alignment with the classical model.

Why this rating

- The curriculum shows solid classical-adjacent components (memory work, rhetoric/writing, liturgical integration, catechesis). However, it does not clearly foreground the full Great Books approach or a formal Seven Liberal Arts framework, which places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Small-class environment (typical 10-14 students) and a focus on relationship, dialogue, and an environment conducive to learning. Public materials emphasize a dialogue-rich communal learning approach and a screen-free policy to promote wonder and memory.
- Restful elements exist (Schol  -like pace and contemplative aspects) in the description of balanced, relationship-based learning; the co-op emphasizes “wonder,” “memory,” and “discipline.”
- Explicit Socratic seminars, debates, or upper-school rhetoric instruction are not clearly documented in public content; references to dialogue and inquiry exist but are not fully mapped to a formal Socratic pedagogy across grades.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): Socratic dialogue; great conversation; dialogue; contemplation; memory work; liturgy-based memory; recitation and chant (inferred from classical-curriculum language); rhetoric opportunities (public-facing references to writing & rhetoric). While the site mentions dialogue and memory, it does not explicitly describe a full Socratic or Harkness-style program, so this is partial.
- Negative Keywords: Lack of explicit, structured Socratic seminars or formal upper-level rhetoric programs in public pages; lack of clearly described project-based or experiential-only pedagogy is noted in the negative keyword lists for some classical models (though not strongly asserted here).

Why this rating

- Pedagogy aligns with some classical practices (memory work, contemplative/restful learning moments, memory-driven recitation-like practice, and a small-class, relationship-based setting). However, explicit, high-fidelity Socratic seminars, formal upper-school rhetoric programs, and a consistent articulation of a “classical pedagogy” across grades are not clearly documented in public materials, placing it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Founders/Directors and a Board with Curriculum Consultants and Tutors are named, showing leadership and mentoring roles. There is evidence of governance and leadership; however, there is less explicit public-facing language about a fully realized “living curriculum” or teacher portraits.

- The presence of a Parent-Led structure and volunteer involvement signals a culture of mentorship and collaborative leadership among families and staff.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): mentors; master-teacher model; portrait of a teacher; teacher as guide; mentoring; living curriculum (though the latter is not explicitly published as a formal description; evidence hints at it through leadership roles).
- Negative Keywords: The public materials do not present a formal, published “faculty Portrait” or formal professional-development language; no explicit “teacher as living curriculum” articulation appears in public content beyond organizational roles.

Why this rating

- Leadership presence and governance exist, with some signals of mentorship culture. However, a fully explicit articulation of the faculty as the living, virtue-embodying curriculum is not clearly published, placing Element 5 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly positions itself as “a Parent-Led Catholic Initiative” and emphasizes founder-family roots. The materials describe Cabrini Co-op as an extension of home and a place where families volunteer and actively participate in governance and day-to-day operations.
- There is a robust emphasis on family involvement, parent formation (folders like Mother Cabrini Mothers), and parent commitment (volunteer roles; fiduciary duties).
- Open-campus style and frequent invitations for parental involvement through meetings, book studies, gatherings, and visits align with classical-parent partnership ideals.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Present Keywords (Positive): Partnership with families; co-educators; parental engagement; home-school hybrid; family catechesis; parent formation; parent covenant; open campus; parent involvement; living tradition in the family. These align with Positive Keywords for Parents & Community in the Six Elements lexicon.
- Negative Keywords: None evident in public content that would signal a consumer-only or minimal-parent-involvement model.

Why this rating

- The school’s materials foreground partnership with parents, formation of families, and ongoing parent engagement—core classical signals for parental partnership and community involvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- If this school aims to elevate from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty to fully CLASSICAL, it could:
- Explicitly publish a Great Books/Great Conversation framework and integrate primary texts into curriculum with structured discussion and evaluation criteria.
- Clearly name and design a Seven Liberal Arts-based curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium) with grade-appropriate milestones and mapping to core subjects.
- Publicly articulate a formal Socratic pedagogical program (e.g., Harkness-style seminars at upper levels) with teacher roles, student roles, and assessment alignment.

- Publish a “portrait of the teacher” and a more explicit “living curriculum” statement that demonstrates how faculty exemplify virtue, wisdom, and mentorship day-to-day.
 - Expand explicit reference to liturgical rites, sacred music, and communal worship as a structured, ongoing element across the grade spectrum, tying to a formal Liturgical Year plan in the curriculum.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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